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Archives, library

3.13.8 Archives, library

References:

Aramaic בֵּית גְּנַז (beyth gnaz) EZR 5:17, EZR 6:1

Greek βιβλιοθήκη (bibliothēkē) 2MA 2:13

Greek βιβλιοφυλάκιον (bibliofulakion) 1ES 6:20, 1ES 6:22

Description and usage:

(Image generated by ChatGPT using OpenAI technology)The library was a place for the storage of official or public documents. There was no distinctive structure for such a building.

Translation:

In 2MA 4:9 several translations render the Greek word *biblion* as “archives” (RSV, GNT). However, here this word refers more to “books” or “records” rather than to the place were those records were kept.